LOGAN SMITH JAMES PHD

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EDUCATION

MCGILL UNIVERSITY (Montréal, Québec)
PhD: Biology. Supervisor: Jon Sakata — 2013 - 2019
BSc: Biology, minor in Linguistics. Dean's honor list — 2009 - 2013

RESEARCH & WORK

Current:

Postdoctoral Fellow: MCGILL UNIVERSITY — 2023 -
Supervisor: Sarah Woolley
Externally funded through the non-profit **EARTH SPECIES PROJECT**

Visiting Research Affiliate: UT AUSTIN. Supervisor: Michael Ryan — 2022 -

Visiting Research Affiliate: YALE UNIVERSITY. Supervisor: Samuel Mehr — 2023 -

Former

Postdoctoral Fellow: SMITHSONIAN TROPICAL RESEARCH INSTITUTE — 2022 - 2023
Supervisor: Rachel Page
Co-supervisors: Michael Ryan, Kimberly Hunter, Ryan Taylor, Sarah Woolley

Postdoctoral Fellow: UT AUSTIN — 2022
Supervisors: Timothy Keitt, Preston Wilson

Postdoctoral Fellow: UT AUSTIN — 2019 - 2022
Supervisor: Michael Ryan
Co-supervisors: Rachel Page, Kimberly Hunter and Ryan Taylor

Research Assistant: MCGILL UNIVERSITY — 2013
Supervisors: Lauren Chapman and Suzanne Gray

Research Assistant: MCGILL UNIVERSITY — 2012
Supervisor: Jon Sakata

Software developer: NOAA (NATIONAL OCEANIC & ATMOSPHERIC ADMINISTRATION) — 2010 - 2012

PUBLICATIONS (SCHOLAR.GOOGLE.COM/CITATIONS?USER=CQOSJTYAAAAJ)

Peer reviewed publications:

27. **James LS**, Oudyk K, Pescaru MI, Wall EM, Chen Y, Pearse WD, Sakata JT (2026). "Pervasive patterns in bird songs resemble those in human speech and song and are independent of vocal learning" ***Science***.

26. **James LS**, Woolley SC, Sakara JT, Hilton CB, Ryan MJ, Mehr SA (2026). "Humans share acoustic preferences with other animals" ***Science***. doi.org/10.1126/science.aea1202

25. **James LS**, Woolley SC*, Ryan MJ* (2025). "A dopamine agonist affects the social decision-making of calling male túngara frogs" ***Hormones and Behavior***. *co-senior authors. doi.org/10.1016/j.yhbeh.2025.105797

24. **James LS**, Ruge O, Sakata JT (2025). "Temporal organization of song modulates vocal learning". ***iScience***. doi.org/10.1016/j.isci.2025.112789

23. **James LS**, O'Mara MT, Touchon JC, Ryan MJ, Bernal XE*, Page RA* (2025). "The ontogeny of decision-making in an eavesdropping predator" ***Proceedings of the Royal Society B*** *co-senior authors. doi.org/10.1098/rspb.2025.0450

22. Sealy BA, **James LS**, Ryan MJ, Page RA (2025) "The influence of hunger and sex on the foraging decisions of frugivorous bats" ***Behavioral Ecology***. doi.org/10.1093/beheco/araf095

21. Galletta KJ, **James LS**, Harp D, Hunter KL, Taylor RC, Ryan MJ, Page RA, Baier AL (2025). "Consistent decisions of a predator facing potentially poisonous prey" ***Animal Behaviour***. doi.org/10.1016/j.anbehav.2025.123318

20. Christiano BM, Weikel MM, **James LS**, Ryan MJ, Page RA (2025) "Ripeness preferences in Seba's short tailed-fruit bats, *Carollia perspicillata*" ***Acta Chiropterologica*** doi.org/10.3161/15081109ACC2025.27.1.007

19. **James LS**, Ryan MJ (2025) "Time and place affect the acoustic structure of frog mating calls" ***Current Zoology***. doi.org/10.1093/cz/zoae039

18. Sealey BA, **James LS**, Cohen G, Ryan MJ, Page RA (2024) "Rapid foraging risk-assessments in the Jamaican fruit eating bat, *Artibeus jamaicensis*" ***Animal Behaviour***. doi.org/10.1016/j.anbehav.2024.07.015

17. **James LS**, Wang AS, Bertolo M, Sakata JT (2023) "Learning to pause: Fidelity of and biases in the developmental acquisition of gaps in the communicative signals of a songbird" ***Developmental Science***. doi.org/10.1111/desc.13382

16. **James LS**, Baier AL, Page RA, Clements P, Hunter KL, Taylor RC, Ryan MJ (2022) "Cross-modal facilitation of auditory discrimination in a frog" ***Biology Letters***. doi.org/10.1098/rsbl.2022.0098

15. **James LS**, Taylor RC, Hunter KL, Ryan MJ (2021). "Evolutionary and allometric insights into anuran auditory sensitivity and morphology" ***Brain, Behavior and Evolution*** **Editor's choice. doi.org/10.1159/000521309

14. **James LS**, Halfwerk W, Hunter KL, Page RA, Taylor RC, Wilson PS, Ryan MJ (2021) "Covariation among multimodal components in the courtship display of the túngara frog" ***Journal of Experimental Biology***. doi.org/10.1242/jeb.241661

13. **James LS**, Mori C, Wada K, Sakata JT (2021) "Phylogeny and mechanisms of shared hierarchical patterns in birdsong" ***Current Biology*****.** doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2021.04.015

12. Kalra S, Yawatkar V, **James LS**, Sakata J, Rajan R (2021) "Introductory gestures before songbird vocal displays are shaped by learning and biological predispositions" ***Proceedings of the Royal Society B***. doi.org/10.1098/rspb.2020.2796

11. **James LS**, Davies R, Mori C, Wada K, Sakata JT (2020) "Manipulations of sensory experiences during development reveal mechanisms underlying vocal learning biases in zebra finches" ***Developmental Neurobiology***. doi.org/10.1002/dneu.22754

10. **James LS**, Sun H, Wada K, Sakata JT (2020) "Statistical learning for vocal sequence acquisition in a songbird" ***Scientific Reports***. doi.org/10.1038/s41598-020-58983-8

9. **James LS***, Fan R*, Sakata JT (2019) "Behavioural responses to video and live presentations of females reveal a dissociation between performance and motivational

aspects of birdsong" ***Journal of Experimental Biology*** *co-first authors. doi.org/10.1242/jeb.206318

8. **James LS**, Sakata JT (2019) "Developmental modulation and predictability of age-dependent vocal plasticity in adult zebra finches" ***Brain Research***. doi.org/10.1016/j.brainres.2019.146336

7. Pearse WD, Morales-Castilla I, **James LS**, Farrell M, Boivin F, Davies TJ (2018) "Complexity is complicated and so too is comparing complexity metrics—a response to Mikula et al. 2018" ***Evolution***. doi.org/10.1111/evo.13450

6. **James LS**, Dai JB, Sakata JT (2018) "Ability to modulate birdsong across social contexts develops without imitative social learning" ***Biology Letters***. doi.org/10.1098/rsbl.2017.0777

5. Pearse WD, Morales-Castilla I, **James LS**, Farrell M, Boivin F, Davies TJ (2018) "Global macroevolution and macroecology of passerine song" ***Evolution***. doi.org/10.1111/evo.13450

4. **James LS**, Sakata JT (2017) "Learning biases underlie "universals" in avian vocal sequencing" ***Current Biology***. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2017.10.019

3. Murphy K, **James LS**, Sakata JT, Prather JF (2017) "Advantages of comparative studies in songbirds to understand the neural basis of sensorimotor integration" ***Journal of Neurophysiology***. doi.org/10.1152/jn.00623.2016

2. **James LS**, Sakata JT (2015) "Predicting plasticity: acute context-dependent changes to vocal performance predict long-term age-dependent changes" ***Journal of Neurophysiology***. doi.org/10.1152/jn.00688.2015

1. **James LS**, Sakata JT (2014) "Vocal motor changes beyond the sensitive period for song plasticity" ***Journal of Neurophysiology***. doi.org/10.1152/jn.00217.2014

Conference proceedings:

1. Mahon M, Hoffman B, **James LS**, Cusimano M, Hagiwara M, Woolley SC, Pietquin O (2025). "Robust detection of overlapping bioacoustic sound events" ***DCASE, NeurIPS 2025***

Invited commentaries:

1. **James LS**, Ryan MJ (2020) "Perspectives regarding future experiments on categorical perception: a comment on Green et al." ***Behavioral Ecology***. doi.org/10.1093/beheco/araa016

Press articles:

2. **James LS** (2026) "You probably agree with the animals on which bird calls, frog noises and cricket chirps are most attractive" ***The Conversation***

1. **James LS**, Bernal XE, Page RA (2025) "Young bats learn to be discriminating when listening for their next meal" ***The Conversation***

Upcoming (preprints):

James LS*, Hoffman B*, Liu JY*, Miron M, Alizadeh M‡, Fernandez E‡, Geist M‡, Kim D‡, Raskin A‡, Sakata JT, Chemla E†, Pietquin O†, Woolley SC† *co-first authors, †co-senior authors, ‡listed alphabetically "Leveraging AI-powered interactive playbacks to decipher rules of communication in zebra finches" ***bioRxiv***

Hamilton ORM, **James LS**, Page RA, Ryan MJ, Taylor RC, Hunter KL (resubmitted). "If memory serves: Multisensory male display improves female memory during mate sampling" ***bioRxiv***

FUNDING/AWARDS

- Wild Animal Initiative fellowship (Co-PI; $180,000)	2026-
- Earth Species Project research fellowship (~$120,000)	2023-
- Smithsonian Post-doctoral Fellowship ($59,450)	2022-2023
- AAAS/Science Program for Excellence in Science	2021
- Biology department day best poster winner	2019
- CRBLM student stipend award ($6000)	2018
- CRBLM travel award ($700)	2018
- Jane Stewart Prize ($500)	2018
- Biology graduate excellence award ($6000)	2018
- CRBLM student stipend award ($6000)	2017
- GREAT travel award ($500)	2017
- CEEB best presentation winner	2016, 2017, 2019
- Heller award ($10,000)	2016
- CEEB runner up best presentation	2015
- International Tuition Waiver (~$66,000)	2013-2019
- GREAT travel award ($500)	2013
- CRBLM travel grant ($700)	2013
- Graduate Excellence Award ($5,000)	2013
- CSBN Student Entrance Stipend ($7,500) (non-competitive)	2013
- Student Undergraduate Research Award ($5,600)	2013
- GREAT travel award ($500)	2013
- Student Undergraduate Research Award ($5,600)	2012
- Richard Adams Award ($825)	2011
- Alma Mater Scholarship ($3,000)	2009

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

International Congress of Neuroethology (ICN; Vancouver; **invited**)	July 2026
CRBLM Summer Showcase (Montreal; **invited**)	July 2026
Symposium: Computational and mechanistic analyses of communicative interactions	June 2026
McGill Biology Department Day (Montreal; **invited plenary talk**)	April 2026
Animal Linguistics Seminar (Linguae Paris virtual; **invited**)	March 2026
Wayne State University seminar (Detroit; **invited**)	March 2026
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (Baltimore)	July 2025
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (London, ON)	June 2024
Barro Colorado Island 100-year symposium (Gamboa, Panama)	June 2024
Gambi talk (Gamboa, Panama)	November 2023
STRI Tupper Talk (Panama City, Panama; **invited**)	November 2023
Mike Ryan at 70 symposium (Austin)	November 2023
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (Portland, OR)	July 2023
STRI Fellows' Symposium (Panama City, Panama)	June 2023
Animal Behavior Society annual (San Jose, Costa Rica)	July 2022

Gamboa frog talk (Gamboa, Panama) June 2022
Earth Species Project seminar (virtual; **invited**) May 2022
BBE seminar at UT Austin (Austin) February 2022
Bridging Brains and Bioacoustics seminar (virtual; **invited**) January 2022
CEEB seminar at McGill (Montreal virtual; **invited**) November 2021
CRBLM seminar: Cultural Evolution of Communication (Montreal; **invited**) November 2021
Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute science talk (virtual; **invited**) September 2021
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (virtual) August 2021
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (virtual) July 2020
Gamboa frog talk (Gamboa, Panama) June 2020
Texas Acoustics seminar (Austin; **invited**) April 2020
CEEB retreat (McGill; best presentation **winner**) March 2019
BBE seminar at UT Austin (Austin; **invited**) November 2018
NB&B seminar series at McGill (Montreal; PhD Seminar) September 2018
CRBLM prosody workshop presentation (Montreal; **invited**) July 2018
Organismal Seminar at McGill (Montreal) May 2018
CEEB retreat at McGill (Montreal) April 2018
SQEBC annual meeting (Ottawa) November 2017
Animal Behavior Society annual meeting (Scarborough) June 2017
NB&B retreat at McGill (Montreal; **invited**) May 2017
CEEB retreat at McGill (Gault; presentation **winner**) April 2017
Linguistics Student Association at Concordia (Montreal; **invited**) October 2016
CEEB retreat at McGill (Gault; best presentation **winner**) April 2016
CRBLM workshop on vocal learning and rhythm (Montreal; **invited**) February 2016
CEEB retreat at McGill (Gault; runner-up best presentation) April 2015
NB&B symposium at McGill (Montreal) April 2015
NB&B seminar at McGill (Montreal) October 2013
CRBLM Data Storm (Montreal) October 2013

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Presented:

James LS, Woolley SC, Ryan MJ "Evoked vocal responses in a frog are modulated by dopamine"
1. International Congress of Neuroethology (Berlin) July 2024

James LS, Woolley SC, Sakata JT, Hilton CB, Mehr SA*, Ryan MJ* "Humans and animals share acoustic preferences" *co-senior author
1. CRBLM scientific day (Montreal) April 2024

James LS, Page RA, Hunter KL, Taylor RC, Ryan MJ "Multimodal production and perception in the túngara frog"
1. STRI Fellows' Symposium (Panama City, Panama) June 2022

James LS, Davies R, Mori C, Wada K, Sakata JT "Motor contributions to vocal sequence learning biases"
1. Society for Neuroscience (San Diego) November 2018
2. Biology Department Day (McGill) – ****Winner best poster** February 2019

James LS, Davies, Sakata JT "Machine learning approaches uncover the acoustic bases of vocal learning biases"
1. CRBLM Scientific Day (Montreal; **competitive**) May 2018

James LS, Sakata JT "Learning biases underlie "universals" in avian vocal sequencing"
1. Montreal Cognitive Science Day (**competitive**) March 2018

James LS, Sakata JT "Experimental evidence for innate biases in vocal communication"
1. Society for Neuroscience (San Diego) November 2016
2. Songbird Satellite Symposium (San Diego) November 2016
3. CRBLM Scientific Day (Montreal; **competitive**) December 2016

James LS, Sakata JT "Predicting plasticity: acute context-dependent changes to vocal performance predict long-term age-dependent changes"
1. Society for Neuroscience (Chicago) October 2015
2. Songbird Satellite Symposium (Chicago) October 2015
3. Biology department day (McGill) October 2015

Sun H, **James LS**, Sakata JT "Statistical learning of acoustic sequences in the Bengalese finch"
1. CRBLM Symposium (Montreal; **competitive**) May 2015
2. IPN retreat (McGill) September 2015

James LS, Sakata JT "Persistence and Predictability of Adult Song Plasticity"
1. Society for Neuroscience (San Diego) November 2013
2. Songbird Satellite Symposium (San Diego) November 2013

James LS, Sakata JT "Natural Vocal Motor Plasticity in Adult Songbirds"
1. CSBN 30th Anniversary Symposium (Concordia) October 2013
2. CRBLM Symposium (Montreal; **competitive**) May 2012

Contributed:
Christiano BM, Weikel MM, **James LS**, Ryan MJ, Page RA (submitted) "Reproductive state influences ripeness preference in Seba's short tailed-fruit bats, *Carollia perspicillata*"
1. STRI Fellows' Symposium (Panama City, Panama) June 2022

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Teaching assistant: Evolution of the brain (BIOL 307) 2016-2018
Average student evaluations: 4.7/5
Guest lectures:
Animal Communication (McGill University) October 2022
Animal Behavior (SUNY Geneseo) October 2021
Syntax 2 (McGill University) November 2015
Animal Communication (McGill University) October 2015
Ramp-UP (NSF) post-baccalaureate mentor at STRI 2023-2024
Supervision of undergraduate research projects: Emily Roberts, Herie Sun*, Cassandra Rogers, Jennifer Dai*, Ronald Davies*, Raina Fan*, Ruth Simberloff, Marina Ramirez, Yijia

Xie, Hannah Mosca, Kevin Zhang, Olivia Ruge*, Franck-Sinclair Wamkeue-Tchagnian, Michaela Bierman, Maria Pescaru

*undergraduate coauthors on peer-reviewed publications

ORGANIZATIONAL SERVICE/OUTREACH

Peer review & conferences

Peer reviewed at journals including: Acta Ethologica, Animal Behaviour, Animal Cognition, Behavioral Ecology, Behavioral Ecology and Sociobiology, Bioacoustics, Biological Journal Linnean Society, Current Biology, Developmental Science, Ecology and Evolution, Ethology Ecology and Evolution, Integrative and Comparative Biology, Journal of Avian Biology, Ornithology, PeerJ, PlosOne, PNAS, Proceeding of the Royal Society B, Royal Society Open Science, Science

VIHAR workshop - scientific committee	2024

Equity and inclusion

IDEA-Tropical website creator (idea-tropical.org)	2021 -
IDEA-Tropical (Inclusion, Diversity, Equity and Access) organizer	2021 -
Panelist (**invited**) – CRBLM Research Ethics Panel (Montreal)	2024
EDI discussion group at UT Austin	2019 - 2021
Founder and organizer: Biology Department Day symposium	2016 - 2019

Campus organizations

Biology graduate student association room manager	2017 - 2018
Biology graduate student association **president**	2016 - 2017
Speaker for post graduate student society (PGSS) council	2015 - 2019
Biology graduate student association councilor	2015 - 2016
Biology representative to the post graduate student society	2014 – 2015

Public outreach

FACE school outreach event with CRBLM (Montreal)	2025
Monthly bat night outreach (Gamboa, Panama)	2020 - 2024
Balboa school visit to STRI – high school outreach (Gamboa, Panama)	2023
Animal Behavior Podcast (Content editor)	2023 - 2025
Explorations: Panorama of Science lab tours (McGill)	2013 – 2019
Canada-wide science fair judge	2016